

mtg-liquidity-signal: the Current Liquidity index

Snapshot 2026-08-22. By Cameraderie Cards. Informational only, not financial advice.

Every existing model in this toolkit tells you *direction*: will a card rise (buy), has it peaked (sell), is it about to be reprinted (brace). None of them tells you whether you can actually **exit**. A perfect sell call is worthless on a card that takes months to move and only at a deep discount. This model fills that gap. It assigns every Magic: The Gathering card a **Current Liquidity** score from 0 to 100: how easily an owner could turn it into cash right now.

What goes into the score

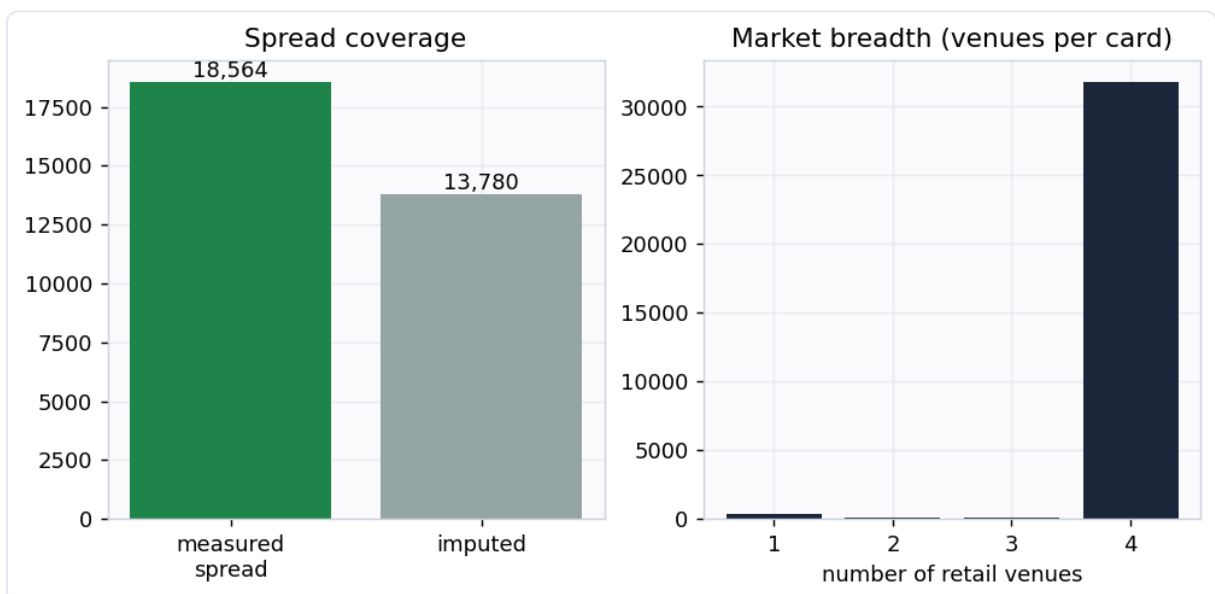
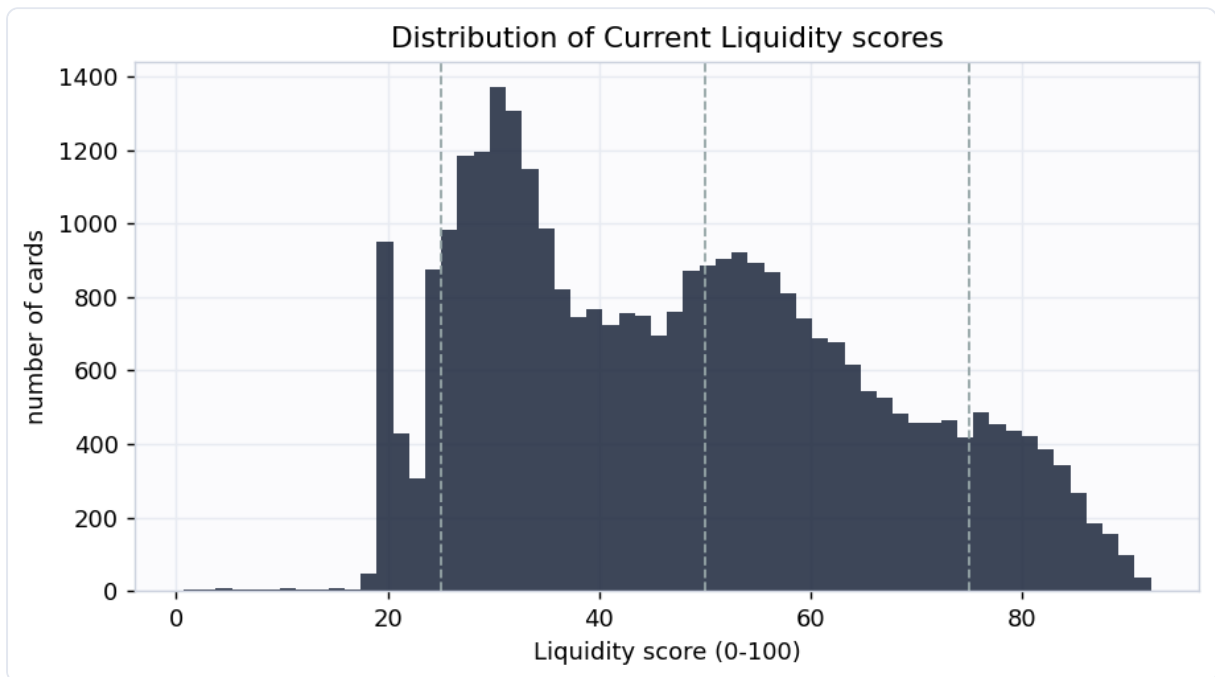
Liquidity is built from four measurable proxies, each normalized to a percentile and blended (weights {'spread': 0.4, 'depth': 0.25, 'activity': 0.2, 'demand': 0.15}):

Component	What it measures	Source
Spread	bid-ask cost to round-trip, CardKingdom buylist vs retail on the same printing	multi-venue price feed
Depth	how many venues list the card, whether a dealer will buy it, cross-venue price agreement	multi-venue price feed
Activity	how often the quoted price actually moves over 120 days (a flat price means nothing is trading)	16-year daily history
Demand	Commander-format popularity (EDHREC)	EDHREC

A card scores high only when it is cheap to exit, sold in many places, actively repricing, and wanted. The weights lean on the spread because that is the cost an owner actually pays to sell.

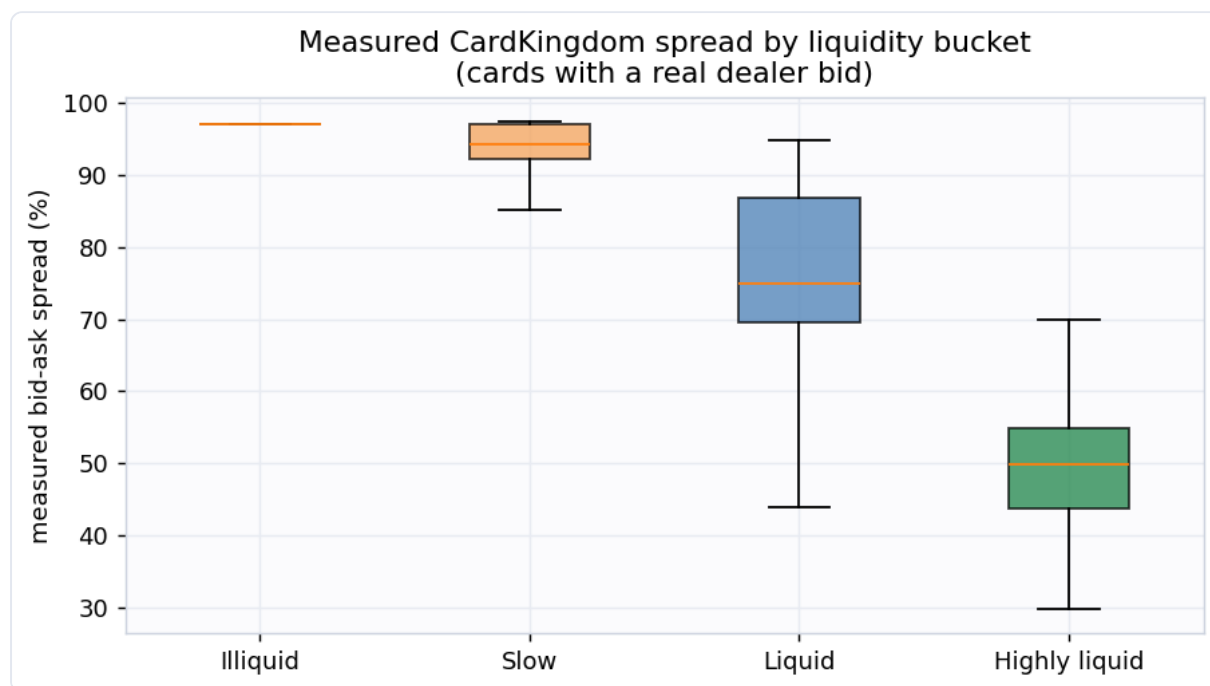
Coverage

Scored **32,344 cards** at this snapshot. **18,564** of them have a real dealer bid (CardKingdom buylist), so their spread is **measured**, not estimated; the median measured spread is **86.4%**. Cards without a dealer bid are flagged `is_imputed` and scored from depth, activity, and demand only.



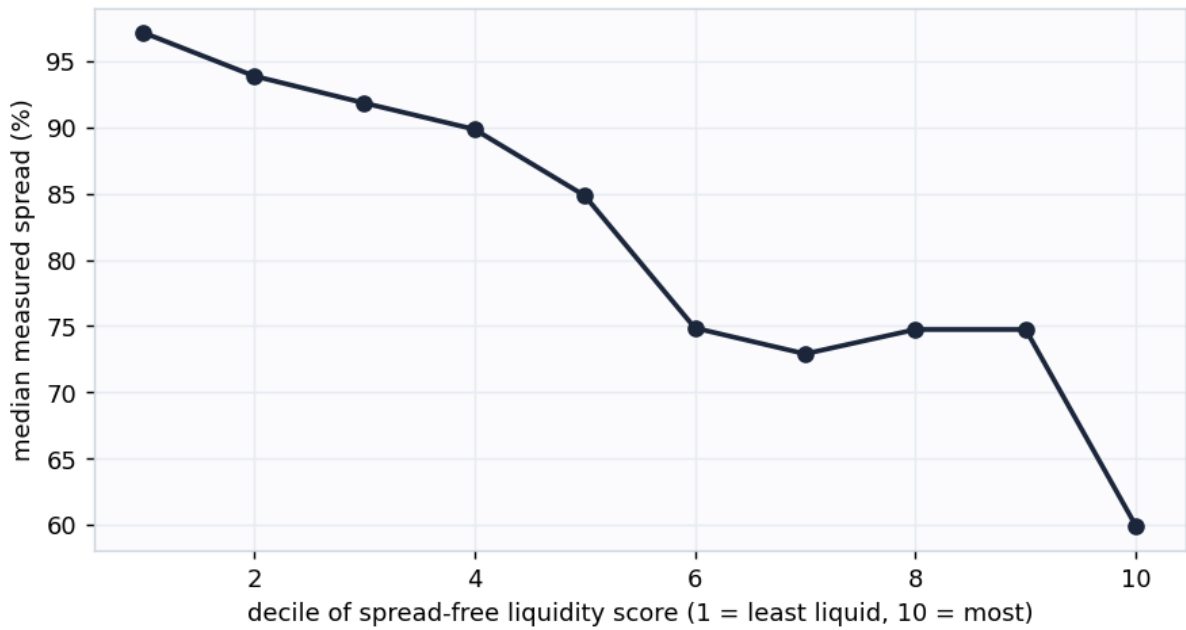
Does the score mean anything? Two honest checks

1. Measured spread lines up with the buckets. Cards the index calls illiquid really do cost more to round-trip. Because the spread is one input to the score, this is partly a consistency check rather than a clean test.



2. Independent proxies predict the spread (the real test). If we rank cards using *only* depth, activity, and demand and deliberately **exclude the spread**, the measured spread still falls steadily as that spread-free score rises (rank correlation **0.459**). The proxies that never saw the spread agree with the spread. That is genuine corroboration, not circular reasoning.

Independent proxies predict the measured spread (spread excluded from this ranking)



Example cards

Example cards (snapshot 2026-08-22)

	Avenger of Zendikar score 92 spread 37%	Channel score 92 spread 34%	Cavern of Souls score 92 spread 35%	Urza's Incubator score 92 spread 36%	Birds of Paradise score 92 spread 39%
Most liquid	When this creature enters, create a 0/1 green Plant creature token for each land you control. Landfall — Whenever a land you control enters, you may put a +1/+1 counter on each Plant creature you control.	Until end of turn, any time you could activate a mana ability, you may pay 1 life. If you do, add Φ to your mana pool. <i>To some mages, the meaning of life is less important than how much is left.</i>	As Cavern of Souls enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. Φ: Add Φ. Φ: Add one mana of any color. Spend this mana only to cast a creature spell of the chosen type, and that spell can't be countered.	As Urza's Incubator enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. Creature spells of the chosen type cost 2 less to cast. <i>"Our recruitments drives are bringing in fewer fresh troops every day. We need a new strategy." —Urza, to Tazem</i>	Flying Φ: Add one mana of any color. <i>The migration of the cranes is believed to be a portent of coming abundance in Wihanda.</i>
Least liquid (> \$5)	Each opponent loses 3 life unless that player sacrifices a nontoken permanent or discards a card. Φ: Destroy target creature. Draw a card. Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver deals 7 damage to each opponent. You draw seven cards.	Equipped creature has first strike and gets +1/+0 for each instant and sorcery card in your graveyard. Whenever equipped creature deals combat damage to a player, you may cast an instant or sorcery spell from your hand with mana value less than or equal to that damage without paying its mana cost. Equip Φ	At the beginning of your upkeep, exile the top card of your library. You may play it this turn. At the beginning of each opponent's upkeep, the next time they would draw a card this turn, instead they exile the top card of their library. They may play it this turn.	When Prosperous Partnership enters the battlefield, create two 1/1 green and white Citizen creature tokens. Tap three untapped creatures you control. Create a Treasure token. <i>Partners in love, partners in life, and partners in crime.</i>	Whenever your opponent chooses a creature in play, he or she can't choose Taoist Hermit. <i>Taoists choose to be hermits for many reasons, but all shared one unchanging goal: to follow the Tao.</i> Illus. Wang Yuxuan

The most liquid cards are heavily played eternal and Commander staples that sell in minutes at a known price. The least liquid expensive cards are thin-market oddities: no dealer will quote a buy price, and they list in only one or two places.

Buckets

Bucket	Score	Cards	Median measured spread
Highly liquid	75-100	3,391	49.9%
Liquid	50-75	10,925	74.9%
Slow	25-50	15,423	94.3%
Illiquid	0-25	2,605	97.1%

How this plugs into the other signals

Liquidity is a multiplier on every other call. It converts "should I sell" into "can I sell, how fast, at what cost," and it filters out illiquid buy candidates the spike model would otherwise flag. In the toolkit's risk-adjusted value equation, the expected value of a position is discounted by its spread and expected time-to-sale to get a **net realizable** value.

Honest limitations

- This is **version 1: a composite proxy index, not a supervised forecast**. It does not carry a held-out AUC because there is no public ground-truth label for "days to sale."
- There is **no true traded-volume or listing-count data yet**. Spread, price staleness, and venue breadth are stand-ins for depth and velocity. The roadmap adds TCGplayer listing counts and sales velocity (the printing table already carries the join key), which will replace the proxies with measured depth.
- Buylist coverage is CardKingdom-only and United States centric. Cards without a CardKingdom bid have an imputed spread and should be read with that caveat.
- Informational only, not financial advice.

Generated by `scripts/build_report.py` from `data/processed/liquidity_features.parquet`.